EM Portfolio Morning Brief — Friday, 23 October 2026

Coverage: full watchlist sweep, news since Thursday 22 Oct. **Data caveat:** the search index was thin for 22–23 Oct; almost no name-specific headlines were dated inside the 24-hour window, so "QUIET" means *nothing found*, not *verified nothing*. Many figures come from secondary summaries; items I could not verify or where sources conflict are flagged. Q3 earnings dates are mostly unconfirmed estimates.

1. Top of the stack

1. **Oil shock / Gulf escalation drives the whole tape.** Brent (Dec) settled at **$113.17 on 22 Oct (+4.0%)**, the highest close since early May, and was ~$114 on 23 Oct on Saudi refined-product shipment restrictions and Hormuz attacks (Nation Thailand, Mitrade). A report that Aramco told Dhahran HQ staff to leave and that seven vessels were hit near Hormuz is single-source (FinanceFeeds) — unconfirmed by a wire. Direct read for PRIO3, GTE, MEDC, Gulf banks/property (Emaar, FAB, SNB, Aramex) and a headwind for importers/EM FX.
2. **Metals and risk sold off; Fed-hike fears into FOMC (27–28 Oct).** Gold ~$4,021, silver ~$54.5 (≈-4.5% on 22 Oct) (Kitco, Business Today); LME copper ~$14,089/t, a five-week low with LME stocks up four days to ~273kt (Mining.com). S&P -1.2%, Nasdaq -2.6% on AI-capex worries; UST 10y fell ~17bp to 4.97% (Investrade). Hits the mining/silver names (PAAS, KTN, VZLA, FCX, FM, IVN, CS, ERO, EQX, AAUC).
3. **Korea: KOSPI -3.52% to 5,533.77 (lowest since April) on chip/AI-capex fears; BOK held at 3.00% but signalled more tightening** (Seoul Economic Daily, JoongAng). Name-specific: **SK Inc** — activist Align Partners disclosed a 1.5% stake (21 Oct), arguing ~75% discount to the SK hynix stake (Korea Times); **LG Electronics pref** — preliminary Q3 op. profit ₩781.8bn, ~17% below consensus.
4. **Indonesia is a live stress point.** On 16 Oct Jakarta stocks fell ~11% (steepest since 1998) on an MSCI proposal to reclassify Indonesia from EM to standalone; rupiah near record low (The Star). Bank Indonesia held 5.75% on 21 Oct (about half of economists expected a hike) and raised the deposit facility rate (IDN Financials). Affects HIDR, BBRI, BRPT, INDF, MEDC, BUKA. MSCI follow-up expected in Nov (date unverified).
5. **Brazil runoff Sunday 25 Oct** (Lula vs Flávio Bolsonaro): Quaest 45–44 for Flávio, a technical tie; final Quaest/Datafolha polls Sat 24 Oct (Forbes Brasil). Binary risk for BBAS3, B3, XP, CYRE3, LREN3, CVCB3, MOVI3, BLTN and BRL.

Position mechanics needing a decision: (a) the US T-bill appears to have **matured 1 Oct 2026** — confirm and remove/roll; (b) **GORO** is now a different issuer (Goldgroup Mining) after the July merger; (c) GTE's $180M 2029-notes amortization was due this month — payment unconfirmed, print 30 Oct.

2. What matters, by region/theme

EM macro thread

- **Dollar/rates:** DXY -0.13% to 101.65 on 22 Oct; USD/JPY 156.74; UST 2y 4.659% (Investrade). MSCI EM futures indicated -2.35% on 22 Oct (indicative only, Investing.com); EEM +0.39% on 21 Oct. No EMBI/EM FX index data found.
- **Fed:** FOMC 27–28 Oct, decision Wed 28 Oct 2:00pm ET (CalendarX). **Current policy rate is unverified** — sources conflict (3.50–3.75% vs 3.75–4.00% after a reported September hike); hold-vs-hike odds are conflicting. Check before relying.
- **China:** Q3 GDP +4.5% y/y (vs 4.4% est.); September retail sales only +1.1%, property investment -20.6% YTD, FAI -7.2% — export-led, weak domestic demand (BabyPips). LPR unchanged for the 17th month (1y 3.0%, 5y 3.5%), next ~20 Nov (Trading Economics). US–China tariff truce reportedly extended to 10 Jan (syndicated Reuters copy; verify) (Northeast Times). No new stimulus, plenum or export-control news found; a late-Oct Politburo economic meeting is assumed from past years, not confirmed.
- **Commodities:** see Top of stack. Lithium: GFEX carbonate ¥104,740/t on 12 Oct, ~half the May peak (Benchmark) — negative for ALB. OPEC+ core members held November output at 31.01m bpd; next meeting 1 Nov (OPEC).

- **Asia rates:** RBI hiked 25bp to 5.50% on 7 Oct, first hike since 2023 (TheTaxCorp, secondary). BSP: one unreliable site reports hikes to 5.00% and a record-low peso; the 22 Oct decision was **not found** — check bsp.gov.ph. Ringgit stable ~4.09 (Business Today MY).
- **Brazil:** next Copom 3–4 Nov. Selic level unconfirmed (13.75% likely, one source 14%; Economic News Brasil). USD/BRL ~5.05 on 19 Oct (BP Money); Ibovespa hit a record ~206.9k after the first round (5 Oct, B3).

Korea

- **SK Inc (034730) — MATTERS.** Align Partners 1.5% stake (above). Earlier: board decision to cancel ~14.7m treasury shares (~20% of issued) on 4 Jan 2027 and a value-up plan expected later this year. SK hynix -5.5% on 22 Oct hits NAV. Q3 early Nov.
- **LG Electronics pref (066575) — MATTERS.** Prelim Q3 operating profit ₩781.8bn (+13.5% y/y, -50% q/q) vs ₩941.7bn consensus, weak LG Innotek; revenue ₩23.83tn (StockHub, secondary).
- **Young Poong (000670) — MATTERS (9 days old).** MBK's call option on Young Poong's ~12% Korea Zinc stake became exercisable ~14 Oct; immediate exercise looks unlikely; combined Young Poong–MBK stake ~41% (Mining Technology).
- **Amorepacific (002790) — NOISE.** Q3 previews mixed (Hana ₩120.6bn vs SK Securities ₩108.4bn) (Asia Economy); results ~5–6 Nov (unconfirmed).
- **Samsung C&T (028260) — NOISE.** Yuanta expects Q3 OP ₩966bn (-2.8%) vs ₩975bn consensus; indirect chip-selloff exposure. **Samsung Life (032830)** — QUIET, same indirect exposure.
- **LG Chem pref (051915)** — QUIET; Q3 late Oct/early Nov (unconfirmed); peer LGES pre-announced ₩756bn OP. **LG Corp (003550)** — QUIET (committed to cancel ₩250bn treasury shares). **LS Corp (006260)** — QUIET (LS Electric data-centre contract raised, unverified aggregator). **Hyosung Corp (004800)** — QUIET (subsidiary US production/backlog items). **SK Discovery (006120)**, **F&F (383220)** — QUIET.
- **Iljin Holdings (015860)** — newly resolved, QUIET. Holds ~49% of Iljin Electric.
- **Policy:** Commercial Act 3rd amendment (mandatory treasury-share cancellation) in force since 6 Mar 2026; existing holdings must be cancelled within 18 months (~Sept 2027) (Legal 500). KRW ~1,325/USD on 21 Oct; 22 Oct close not found.

Greater China / HK / Taiwan

- **Daqo (DQ) — MATTERS.** Q3 results confirmed **Tue 27 Oct**, pre-US open, call 8:00am ET (Finviz). Polysilicon rallied ~27% in August to ~RMB40.5/kg on anti-involution policy but inventory >540kt, so the move is fragile (SMM); no October price found.
- **TSMC (2330) — MATTERS (15 Oct, not 24h).** Q3 revenue $46.72bn (+41% y/y) vs guidance $44.6–45.8bn, GM 66.4%, Q4 guide $52.3–54.3bn; 2nm ramp dilutes margin ~3–4pts (TSMC). Exposed to the 22 Oct AI-capex selloff. October sales ~10 Nov.
- **BYD (1211) — MATTERS (modestly).** Sept NEV sales 463,561 (+17%), Q3 1.32m (+18.8%), ending four straight quarters of y/y declines; 9M -3.9% (CnEVPost). Q3 results ~28–30 Oct (inferred); October sales ~1 Nov.
- **Ping An (2318)** — QUIET; Q3 board meeting likely ~27–30 Oct (inferred from 28 Oct 2025; notice not found). 9M25 base: net profit RMB132.9bn (iTiger).
- **JD.com (9618)** — QUIET; Q2 revenue RMB346.4bn (-2.9%), op. margin 1.3% (SA); Q3 likely mid-Nov. **KWEB LN** — no LN-line data; follows China internet; the broad market is the driver.
- **DiDi, Dingdong, Hello Group, HUYA, Hepsiburada** — QUIET; no Q3 dates found (mostly mid-Nov+). Dingdong: independent director change 1 Oct (NOISE). HUYA raised buyback to $100M total (7 Aug). Hello Group Q2 net income RMB237m, overseas +52%. Hepsiburada Q2 EBITDA fell to TRY239m from TRY977m; TRY9.3bn capital increase approved 14 Aug (İş Yatırım).
- **361 Degrees (1361)** — confirmed; QUIET; H1 revenue +8% to RMB6.16bn, but mainland stores fell to 5,076 from 5,394 (SGI Europe). **Bank of East Asia (23)** — QUIET (unexplained -5.9% on 8 Oct). **China BlueChemical (3983)**, **China Dongxiang (3818)** — confirmed; QUIET (Dongxiang flagged an FY loss of up to RMB180m; interim late Nov).

Brazil / LatAm

- **América Móvil (AMX) — NOISE.** Q3 (20 Oct): revenue MXN251bn (+7.6%), EBITDA MXN102bn (+8.9%), postpaid net adds 3.1M, 5.0M prepaid disconnections from base clean-ups (Rio Times).
- **Cyrela (CYRE3) — MATTERS.** Q3 operating preview (13 Oct): launches R$2.86bn (-16%), net sales R$2.12bn (-14%), 12m VSO 40.3% vs 48.9%; stock fell >5% (Vis no Invest). Election-sensitive.
- **Banco do Brasil (BBAS3) — MATTERS (credit).** 1H26 adjusted profit R$7.3bn, -34% y/y on agri/retail delinquency (Acionista); Q3 likely mid-Nov. State-bank sentiment swings on the runoff.
- **Gran Tierra (GTE) — MATTERS.** Q3 on **30 Oct**. Company said it had a path to cover the $180M October 2026 amortization of its 2029 notes (SEC); no news found on whether it was paid. Brent is the driver.
- **PRIO3** — MATTERS via oil; Q2 production 172 kbpd, record EBITDA $879M (Nord); price data conflicting; Q3 early Nov (inferred).
- **BrasilAgro (AGRO3)** — NOISE; FY26 adj. EBITDA R$99M (-63%); EGM 21 Oct (R$30M interim dividends); payment 16 Nov (SEC).
- **B3, XP, Bunge, Lojas Renner, Movida, CVC** — QUIET. XP Q3 ~16 Nov (estimate); Bunge Q3 early Nov (unconfirmed; 2026 EPS guide $9.00–9.50 from a low-quality source); Renner JCP paid 14 Oct; Movida Q2 profit R$135.6M (2x y/y); CVC's August +13% jump was technical.
- **Mexico/Colombia:** Banxico held 6.50% after the May cut; nothing newer. COP strong ~3,273.

Middle East / Africa / Europe

- **Saudi National Bank (SNB) — MATTERS.** Q3 net profit SAR6.45bn (-0.3% y/y), below ~SAR6.7bn forecast; 9M SAR19.47bn (+4.5%) (Argaam).
- **Emaar — NOISE/mild.** Alabbar: $16–17bn planned Syria investment (14 Oct); Dubai August price/sq ft -1.7% y/y, first annual fall since 2021 (secondary). Q3 early Nov (unconfirmed).
- **MTN — pending MATTERS.** $6.2bn IHS takeover: Nigeria's FCCPC cleared it 24 Aug with a sell-down condition (Nairametrics); a Guardian headline says completed (link) but date/finality unverified — **resolve first**. SA local elections 4 Nov: risk for MTN/Absa/rand.
- **TBC Bank (TBCG)** — Q3/9M results **6 Nov**, 07:00 GMT (Investegate); H1 profit GEL751m (+13%), ROE >23%.
- **FAB** — QUIET; Q3 likely within window (Q3'25 came in October). H1 growth figures conflict across sources. **Alpha Dhabi** — QUIET; H1 profit AED9.8bn (+48%), partly marks on AI holdings (WAM). **Aramex** — QUIET; Q3 ~11 Nov; CEO naming conflicts across sources. **Yamama Cement (YACCO)** — QUIET; third clinker line commercial since 1 Jul. **Absa** — QUIET (Thunes partnership, noise). **Prosus** — QUIET; trades at discount to NAV/Tencent stake.
- **ETFs (newly resolved): HIDR** (HSBC MSCI Indonesia) — MATTERS via the 16 Oct shock; **EMGA** (iShares JPM EM Local Govt Bond) — QUIET, rate/FX-driven; **BLTN** (iShares Brazil LTN) — QUIET, runoff/Copom exposure.

Southeast Asia / India / Japan / funds

- **ReNew (RNW) — MATTERS.** CPPIB and Sumant Sinha non-binding take-private proposal at **$6.75/share** (reported 28 May; date unverified); no October update found (StockAnalysis).
- **Medco (MEDC) — MATTERS (mild).** 12 Oct: acquiring 10% participating interest in four PSCs from Eni (headline only) (Kabar Bursa); Sambar first production targeted Q4.
- **BBRI** — QUIET; 1H profit IDR31.2tn (+17.5%), NPL 3.15%; Q3 due late Oct. **Barito (BRPT)** — 1H profit -65%. **Indofood (INDF)** — NOISE; weak rupiah/commodities squeeze margin (Kontan). **Bukalapak (BUKA)** — QUIET; 9M results ~end-Oct.
- **Ayala Land, GT Capital** — QUIET (ALI 1H profit -19%; GTCAP 1Q profit PHP8.9bn). **Genting (GENT)** — QUIET; Q3 late Nov. **Bank of India, Reliance** — QUIET; Q2 FY27 dates unconfirmed (Reliance reported 17 Oct last year; check NSE whether already out). **Suzuki (7269)** — NOISE (OP guide cut ¥30bn to ¥540bn). **Universal Entertainment (6425)** — QUIET; H1 net profit just ¥62m, S&P B-.
- **VEIL** — QUIET; discount 8.9% (June monthly average, last found); board intends two further 10% tenders within 12 months (Jan tender at NAV-3%) (Edison). **VOF** — QUIET; discount ~20.2% (end-May), no tender; October figures not found for either.

Metals & mining / US-listed

- **Teck (TECK) — MATTERS.** Q3 **Thu 29 Oct** pre-market (Finviz); Anglo–Teck merger not yet closed, awaiting Investment Canada and global (incl. China) approvals, completion targeted late 2026/early 2027 (Engineering News).
- **Freeport (FCX) — MATTERS.** Q3 **Tue 27 Oct** pre-market, call 10am ET (one aggregator says 23 Oct; company-sourced is 27 Oct). Grasberg mill ~67% of normal; ~60koz gold sales slipped to Q4 (SEC).
- **First Quantum (FM) — MATTERS.** Q3 **Wed 28 Oct** after TSX close, call 29 Oct 9am ET (FinancialContent); Cobre Panamá restart prep, no October news.
- **Pan American (PAAS)** — Q3 4 Nov after close, call 5 Nov (Investing News); silver drop is the driver.
- **Ivanhoe (IVN)** — QUIET; 2026 Cu guide cut to 290–310kt; DRC concentrate export ban (Aug, secondary); Q3 date unknown (30 Oct last year). **Capstone (CS)** — QUIET; Q3 date unknown (historically late Oct). **Ero (ERO)** — Q3 ~4–5 Nov (inferred). **Equinox (EQX)** — Q3 production on track for 870–920koz; Orla combination closed 31 Jul; financials ~4 Nov (projected) (Finviz).
- **Albemarle (ALB)** — QUIET on news, sector MATTERS (lithium down); Q3 ~4–5 Nov (unverified). **Allied Gold (AAUC)** — QUIET; Zijin cash deal reportedly terminated (headline-level); Kurmuk start-up expected Q3. **Kootenay (KTN)**, **Vizsla (VZLA)** — QUIET, silver-beta.
- **GORO — CORPORATE CHANGE.** Gold Resource Corp merged into Goldgroup Mining (closed 17 Jul 2026; 0.3619 Goldgroup share per GRC after 4:1 consolidation); legacy GRC delisted; Goldgroup now trades as GORO on NYSE American (SEC 8-K).

3. Probably noise

- Amorepacific Q3 previews — brokers differ by ~10%; wait for the print.
- Samsung C&T / Samsung Life — chip-selloff read-through only.
- AMX Q3 — in line; prepaid "disconnections" are base clean-ups.
- Dingdong independent-director swap; Absa–Thunes partnership (low-grade source, terms undisclosed).
- Emaar Syria investment talk and one month of Dubai price data.
- Suzuki Q1 guide cut — already out in August.
- CVC's August jump (analysts: technical).
- Hello Group/HUYA/JD/DiDi — Q2/Q1 prints months old; no fresh catalyst.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

Mechanics

- **US T-bill (listed CUSIP 912797SA68):** the entry has 10 characters (a CUSIP has 9). Closest match 912797SA6 shows maturity **1 Oct 2026** on an HSBC holdings file (HSBC) — **likely matured 22 days ago; not verified on TreasuryDirect.** Confirm the CUSIP; update `watchlist-em.md`.
- **VEIL/VOF:** monitor discount RNS (early Nov) and any second VEIL tender; VOF ~20% discount, no tender.
- **Preferreds:** LG Chem pref (051915) and LG Electronics pref (066575) — LGE prelim miss hits the pref; no pref-specific mechanics found.
- **Deals/regulatory:** Anglo–Teck approvals (China pending); RNW take-private ($6.75, non-binding); MTN–IHS closing; Young Poong/MBK Korea Zinc option; SK Inc activist and 4 Jan 2027 cancellation; MSCI Indonesia reclassification (Nov); GORO issuer change.

Calendar (to ~6 Nov; "est." = unconfirmed)

Date	Event
Sat 24 Oct	Final Quaest/Datafolha polls (Brazil)

Date	Event
Sun 25 Oct	**Brazil presidential runoff**
Tue 27 Oct	**Daqo Q3** (confirmed); **Freeport Q3** (confirmed)
27–28 Oct	**FOMC** (decision 28 Oct, 2pm ET)
Wed 28 Oct	**First Quantum Q3** after close (call 29 Oct)
Thu 29 Oct	**Teck Q3**; Vale (read-through)
~27–30 Oct	Ping An Q3, BYD Q3 (est.)
Late Oct	BBRI, Bukalapak, LG Chem, Samsung C&T Q3; FAB, Yamama (est.)
Fri 30 Oct	**Gran Tierra Q3** (notes amortization)
1 Nov	OPEC+ core meeting; BYD October sales (est.)
3 Nov	Itaú (Brazil read-through)
3–4 Nov	**Copom**
4 Nov	South Africa local elections; PAAS Q3 after close; ALB, EQX, ERO (est.)
~5–6 Nov	Amorepacific, SK Inc and Korean Q3s (est.); **TBC Bank Q3 (6 Nov)**
Nov (TBD)	MSCI Indonesia decision; Emaar, Alpha Dhabi Q3 (est.)

5. Follow-up questions

1. **T-bill:** confirm the correct 9-character CUSIP and maturity on TreasuryDirect; has the position been rolled?
2. **Gran Tierra:** was the $180M October amortization paid, and from cash or new financing? What does the 30 Oct print say about liquidity at $110+ Brent?
3. **MTN:** has the IHS acquisition closed, and with what Nigeria sell-down terms?
4. **SK Inc:** does Align's 1.5% stake change the odds of a larger value-up plan, and how exposed is NAV to the SK hynix drawdown?
5. **HIDR/BBRI/INDF:** what is the MSCI Indonesia consultation timeline and potential passive outflow; are BI's measures enough to stabilise IDR?
6. **Brazil:** how are BBAS3, CYRE3 and BLTN positioned for either runoff outcome; what is the actual Selic level?
7. **Fed:** what is the verified policy rate and hike probability going into 28 Oct, and what does it mean for EMGA and EM FX?
8. **Teck:** where does Chinese SAMR approval of Anglo–Teck stand?
9. **ReNew:** any update from the special committee on the $6.75 CPPIB/Sinha proposal?
10. **Daqo/polysilicon:** has the August price rally held into October?
11. **Gulf:** can the Dhahran evacuation/seven-vessel report be confirmed by a wire, and what is the read for FAB, Emaar, SNB?
12. **VEIL:** timing of the second 10% tender and current (October) discount; same for VOF.

Watchlist changes made this run

- 015860 KS → **Iljin Holdings** (resolved; not Iljin Materials).
- HIDR LN → **HSBC MSCI Indonesia UCITS ETF** (resolved, ~90%).
- EMGA LN → **iShares J.P. Morgan EM Local Govt Bond UCITS ETF USD (Acc)** (resolved, ~90%; benchmark likely GBI-EM).
- BLTN NA → **iShares Brazil LTN BRL Govt Bond UCITS ETF** (resolved, ~70%; confirm ISIN/venue).
- YACCO AB → **Yamama Cement** (Tadawul 3020; ~85–90%; not Yanbu).
- GORO US → **Goldgroup Mining (formerly Gold Resource Corp)**, merger closed 17 Jul 2026.

- Confirmed: 1361 HK, 3983 HK, 3818 HK, ALPHADHA, KTN. 002790 is the holding entity (ticker not seen printed; verify). Not independently verified this run: 383220, 004800, 051915, 066575, 006260, 006120, 000670 (match prior knowledge).
- T-bill flagged as probably matured; entry kept pending confirmation.

Email delivery: see end-of-run summary.